

Unit 1 — Age of Revolutions

Absolutism to Revolution · 1600s–1789 · W.01–W.08a · Q1

Essential Question: *How did ideas about the source of political power shift from the divine right of kings to the consent of the governed?*

Absolutism & the Divine Right of Kings

Describe the concept of the divine right of kings as well as the features, strengths, and weaknesses of European absolutism, including Louis XIV, Versailles, and Peter the Great. (C, H, P)

I can...

- define absolutism and the divine right of kings
- describe the strengths and weaknesses of absolute monarchy using evidence
- compare the reigns of Louis XIV at Versailles and Peter the Great in Russia

Hook

If a king says God Himself chose him to rule, who is left with the authority to tell him no?

Key terms

absolutism /AB-suh-loo-tiz-um/ <i>ES: absolutismo</i>	a system in which a monarch holds total, centralized power over the state
divine right /duh-VINE rye/ <i>ES: derecho divino</i>	the belief that a monarch's authority to rule comes directly from God
Versailles /vair-SY/ <i>ES: Versalles</i>	Louis XIV's vast palace, used to control the French nobility by keeping them at court
boyar /boh-YAR/ <i>ES: boyardo</i>	a Russian noble whose independent power Peter the Great worked to reduce
westernization /wes-ter-nih-ZAY-shun/ <i>ES: occidentalización</i>	adopting western European customs, technology, and institutions, as Peter the Great pushed in Russia

Primary source — analyze with HIPPO

“L'état, c'est moi” — 'I am the state,' the phrase long associated with Louis XIV's absolute rule.”

Portrait of Louis XIV in Coronation Robes. Hyacinthe Rigaud, 1701. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Rigaud_Louis_XIV_1701.jpg
Image drops in from the primary-source bank at build; citation shown above.

Cornell cues — capture these

- What is absolutism, in one sentence?
- How did divine right justify a king's power?
- How did Versailles make the nobility depend on the king?
- How was Peter the Great's absolutism similar to and different from Louis XIV's?
- One strength and one weakness of absolute rule?

Make It Stick — check for understanding

Which statement best explains the idea of the divine right of kings?

- A. A monarch's authority comes directly from God and cannot be questioned by subjects ✓
- B. A monarch's power is granted and limited by an elected assembly
- C. A monarch must share power equally with the nobility
- D. A monarch is chosen by a popular vote of the people

Answer: A · DOK 2. Reveal after students commit (mark it, say it, or explain it).

Access for every learner

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Limiting the Monarch: Magna Carta & the English Bill of Rights

Compare documents that establish limits on government in response to absolute monarchy (e.g., the Magna Carta and the English Bill of Rights). (H, P)

I can...

- compare the Magna Carta and the English Bill of Rights
- explain how these documents limited the monarch and built a constitutional monarchy
- contrast England's constitutional monarchy with continental absolute monarchies

Hook

What if a single piece of paper could tell a king, 'Even you must obey the law'?

Key terms

Magna Carta /MAG-nuh KAR-tuh/ <i>ES: Carta Magna</i>	a 1215 English charter forcing the king to accept that he too was under the law
English Bill of Rights /.../ <i>ES: Declaración de Derechos inglesa</i>	a 1689 document giving Parliament key powers and listing rights the monarch could not violate
constitutional monarchy /kon-stih-TOO-shun-ul MON-ar-kee/ <i>ES: monarquía constitucional</i>	a monarchy whose power is limited by law and a governing body such as Parliament
rule of law /rool uv law/ <i>ES: estado de derecho</i>	the principle that everyone, including the ruler, is subject to the law
Parliament /PAR-luh-ment/ <i>ES: Parlamento</i>	England's law-making body, whose power over taxes and laws grew as the monarch's shrank

Primary source — analyze with HIPPO

“Clause 39 of Magna Carta: no free man shall be imprisoned or stripped of rights 'except by the lawful judgment of his equals or by the law of the land.'”

Magna Carta (1215) - BL Cotton MS Augustus II 106. Unknown, 1215. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Magna_Carta_\(1215\)_-_BL_Cotton_MS_Augustus_II_106.jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Magna_Carta_(1215)_-_BL_Cotton_MS_Augustus_II_106.jpg)

Image drops in from the primary-source bank at build; citation shown above.

Cornell cues — capture these

- What did Magna Carta (1215) force the king to accept?
- What powers did the English Bill of Rights (1689) give Parliament?
- What is a constitutional monarchy?
- How is England different from absolute France?
- Which right in these documents still matters today?

Make It Stick — check for understanding

What key idea do BOTH the Magna Carta and the English Bill of Rights establish?

- A. The monarch's power should be unlimited
- B. The monarch is also bound by law and cannot rule without limits ✓**
- C. The monarchy should be abolished entirely
- D. Only the church may limit the king

Answer: B · DOK 2. Reveal after students commit (mark it, say it, or explain it).

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The Enlightenment: Reason, Rights & Government

Compare the major ideas of philosophers during the Age of Enlightenment, such as Charles-Louis de Montesquieu, Thomas Hobbes, John Locke, and Jean-Jacques Rousseau. (C, E, H, P)

I can...

- identify the causes of the Enlightenment, including the emphasis on human reason
- compare the major ideas of Montesquieu, Hobbes, Locke, and Rousseau
- connect each thinker's key work to its central argument

Hook

If people could redesign government from scratch using only reason, what would they build?

Key terms

Enlightenment /en-LY-ten-ment/ <i>ES: la Ilustración</i>	a 1600s–1700s movement applying reason to human nature, society, and government
natural rights /NACH-ur-ul rytes/ <i>ES: derechos naturales</i>	rights (life, liberty, property) that Locke argued all people have simply by being human
social contract /SOH-shul KON-trakt/ <i>ES: contrato social</i>	the idea that government is an agreement between rulers and the people
separation of powers /.../ <i>ES: separación de poderes</i>	Montesquieu's idea of dividing government into branches so no one part dominates
popular sovereignty /POP-yuh-lur SOV-rin-tee/ <i>ES: soberanía popular</i>	Rousseau's idea that legitimate authority rests with the general will of the people

Primary source — analyze with HIPPO

“Locke, Second Treatise of Government: all people have rights to 'life, liberty, and property,' and government exists to protect them.”

Portrait of John Locke. Godfrey Kneller, 1697. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain. [https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Godfrey_Kneller_-_Portrait_of_John_Locke_\(Hermitage\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Godfrey_Kneller_-_Portrait_of_John_Locke_(Hermitage).jpg)
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Cornell cues — capture these

- What caused the Enlightenment's faith in reason?
- Hobbes: why does he favor a strong ruler?
- Locke: what are natural rights and the purpose of government?
- Montesquieu vs. Rousseau: separation of powers vs. the general will?
- Which idea shows up in modern governments?

Make It Stick — check for understanding

John Locke argued that the main purpose of government is to

- A. expand the ruler's divine authority
- B. enforce a single official religion
- C. protect people's natural rights to life, liberty, and property ✓**
- D. keep power in the hands of the nobility

Answer: C · DOK 2. Reveal after students commit (mark it, say it, or explain it).

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The English Civil War & Constitutional Monarchy

Examine the causes and consequences of the English Civil War. (C, G, H, P)

I can...

- describe the causes of the English Civil War and the roles of key people (James I, Charles I, Cromwell, Charles II)
- explain the consequences, including the creation of a constitutional monarchy (William and Mary, James II)
- connect the conflict to the Glorious Revolution and the English Bill of Rights

Hook

What happens to the idea of divine right the moment a people put their own king on trial?

Key terms

English Civil War /.../ <i>ES: Guerra Civil inglesa</i>	the 1640s conflict between supporters of the king and of Parliament
Oliver Cromwell /OL-ih-ver KROM-wel/ <i>ES: Oliver Cromwell</i>	Parliament's general who led the overthrow of Charles I and ruled the Commonwealth
Charles I /.../ <i>ES: Carlos I</i>	the king whose clashes with Parliament led to civil war and his execution in 1649
Glorious Revolution /GLOR-ee-us rev-uh-LOO-shun/ <i>ES: Revolución Gloriosa</i>	the 1688 replacement of James II with William and Mary, who accepted limits on royal power
constitutional monarchy /kon-stih-TOO-shun-ul MON-ar-kee/ <i>ES: monarquía constitucional</i>	a monarchy limited by law and Parliament

Primary source — analyze with HIPPO

“The 1649 execution of Charles I was the first time a reigning English king was tried and put to death by his own subjects.”

The Execution of Charles I. Unknown, c. 1649. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain. https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:The_Execution_of_Charles_I.png
Image drops in from the primary-source bank at build; citation shown above.

Cornell cues — capture these

- What conflicts between king and Parliament caused the war?
- What was the role of Charles I? Of Oliver Cromwell?
- What happened to Charles I in 1649?
- What was the Glorious Revolution?
- How did the war lead to constitutional monarchy?

Make It Stick — check for understanding

One major consequence of the English Civil War and the Glorious Revolution was that

- A. England became an absolute monarchy like France
- B. the divine right of kings was strengthened
- C. England abolished Parliament permanently
- D. the English monarch's power became limited by Parliament and law ✓**

Answer: D · DOK 2. Reveal after students commit (mark it, say it, or explain it).

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From the Enlightenment to the Declaration of Independence

Identify how the ideas of the Enlightenment inspired Thomas Jefferson and the Declaration of Independence. (C, G, H, P)

I can...

- identify Enlightenment ideas (natural rights, consent of the governed) in the Declaration of Independence
- connect Locke's ideas to Jefferson's wording
- explain how Enlightenment thought crossed from Europe into a real revolution

Hook

When Jefferson wrote 'Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness,' whose century-old ideas was he borrowing?

Key terms

Declaration of Independence /.../ <i>ES: Declaración de Independencia</i>	the 1776 document declaring the American colonies free and stating their guiding principles
Thomas Jefferson /.../ <i>ES: Thomas Jefferson</i>	the Declaration's main author, who drew heavily on Enlightenment thought
unalienable rights /un-AY-lee-un-uh-bul rytes/ <i>ES: derechos inalienables</i>	rights that cannot be taken away — Jefferson's version of Locke's natural rights
consent of the governed /.../ <i>ES: consentimiento de los gobernados</i>	the principle that a government's authority comes from the people it rules
self-evident /self-EV-ih-dent/ <i>ES: evidente por sí mismo</i>	a truth so obvious that reason alone proves it — Enlightenment language in the Declaration

Primary source — analyze with HIPPO

“Declaration of Independence (1776): ‘We hold these truths to be self-evident, that all men are created equal... endowed... with certain unalienable Rights... Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness.’”

Engrossed Declaration of Independence, front. Unknown, 1776. Wikimedia Commons. Public domain.
https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Engrossed_Declaration_of_Independence,_front.jpg
Image drops in from the primary-source bank at build; citation shown above.

Cornell cues — capture these

- Which Enlightenment ideas appear in the Declaration?
- How does 'unalienable rights' echo Locke's natural rights?
- What does 'consent of the governed' mean?
- How is 'self-evident' Enlightenment language?
- Why does this show ideas can cause revolutions?

Make It Stick — check for understanding

The Declaration of Independence's phrase 'unalienable Rights... Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness' most directly reflects the ideas of

- A. John Locke ✓
- B. Thomas Hobbes
- C. Louis XIV
- D. Oliver Cromwell

Answer: A · DOK 2. Reveal after students commit (mark it, say it, or explain it).

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